

have arrived at a fairly standardized system through which anyone can leverage the power of digital editing.

NLE or Non-Linear Editing

Before we dive deeper into the nitty gritty world of each individual editing systems for audio, image and video, it would serve us well to familiarise ourselves with the concept of non-linear editing. In the old days, editing was done from physical tapes and similar storage mediums. Eventually, the editing would be done by hand where recording material, whether it is photo paper or magnetic tapes, needed to be physically altered to arrive at the finished product. In this way the linear editing process was when content was recorded in linear segments from one medium to another, also known as “tape to tape”, where the order of content was determined on paper and then manually organised.



Today a single laptop is capable of editing together cutting edge movies using a video editing software.

It became paramount to observe the best of precautions and protocols since these tangible objects were the raw material from which the final product would be created. Any damage, error or misplacement would be a huge financial and personal loss to the creators. However, with the advent of digital

processes, all the recording materials became nothing but a series of bits and bytes that could be manipulated without fear of permanent loss. This form of editing came to be known as non-linear editing and has more specific definitions across different mediums but broadly can be understood to be the ability to edit multimedia materials in a non-linear format, where replication, reorganisation and revision can happen in any order irrespective of how the material was created. Due to this reason most digital editing tools are known as NLEs or non-linear editing tools.

Layout, Workflow and Essential Tools of Video Editors

Perhaps the most exciting, engaging and popular form of multimedia formats is video. In this discussion we shall consider all forms of moving